

Vernard Mercader

Hybrid UX Designer & Frontend UI Engineer · Active TS/SCI Clearance

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SUMMARY

Hybrid UX Designer and Frontend UI Engineer with over 10 years of cross-functional experience delivering accessible, high-consequence digital products across defense, public-sector, and commercial platforms. Specialist in WCAG 2.1/2.2 AA & AAA compliance, Section 508 accessibility remediation, design system governance, and modern React/TypeScript architectures.

CORE COMPETENCIES

ACCESSIBILITY & STANDARDS	WCAG 2.1/2.2 AA & AAA, Section 508, ARIA Semantics, Assistive Tech Audits (Screen Readers, Voice Control), Color Contrast Calibration
UX & PRODUCT DESIGN	Heuristic Evaluation, Journey Mapping, Service Blueprinting, Information Architecture, Usability Testing, Rapid Prototyping, Figma, Miro
FRONTEND ENGINEERING	React, TypeScript, Next.js, Angular, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, Material UI (MUI), Bootstrap, U.S. Web Design System (USWDS)
CLOUD & PLATFORMS	AWS Amplify, GraphQL, REST APIs, Git/GitLab, Docker, DevSecOps, ArcGIS Geospatial COP, WordPress Multisite, Linux

PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

Frontend UI Developer

Krozak Technologies (United States Coast Guard)

JUL 2026 – PRESENT

Silver Spring, MD (Remote)

- Design and engineer responsive, accessible **React and TypeScript** user interfaces for Coast Guard applications, translating complex operational UX requirements and Figma wireframes into production component libraries.
- Develop and integrate frontend data workflows utilizing **AWS Amplify, GraphQL, and REST APIs** within an Agile/DevSecOps delivery pipeline.
- Architect mobile-ready and offline-capable interface experiences while enforcing strict adherence to **WCAG 2.1 AA** accessibility standards and military usability baselines.

Independent Consultant & Founder

Logias (UX & Accessibility Consultancy)

NOV 2025 – PRESENT

Western Massachusetts

- Increased mobile-order adoption **16%** and reduced customer order complaints by **42%** for Burger King by auditing conversion friction and restructuring pickup location selection flows.
- Delivered comprehensive **WCAG baseline audits and 6-page heuristic evaluations** against Nielsen standards for EDMO (Edventure More), projecting a 20–35% lift in enrollment conversions.
- Authored veteran-player retention audit for Niantic's Pokémon GO, identifying critical cognitive overhead, multi-tap interaction friction, and clunky inventory routines driving user churn.

UI Engineer & UX Design Lead

Oteemo (United States Air Force – Platform One)

MAY 2023 – NOV 2025

Reston, VA (Remote)

- Elevated internal accessibility score from **62 to 91 points** by directing the UI overhaul and brand transition of the Vulnerability Assessment Tool (VAT) for Iron Bank under Platform One.
- Rearchitected frontend infrastructure by migrating legacy Bootstrap to **Material UI (MUI) in React TypeScript**, enforcing Section 508 accessibility compliance and dark/light modes.
- Decreased pull request cycle times by **10%** through a unified Figma-to-code design system and automated repo-level semantic HTML and ARIA linting routines.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. in Digital Entertainment & Game Design

ITT Tech · Everett, WA

A.A.S. in Multimedia / Design

ITT Tech · Everett, WA

B.S. in Computer Science

Lyceum University · Manila, Philippines

Active TS/SCI Security Clearance

Department of Defense / Federal Adjudication (Reinvestigated 2026)

Google UX Design Professional Certificate

Coursera / Google Career Certification

Adobe Certified Expert (ACE) & Professional (ACP)

Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop, Premiere Pro, After Effects

Interaction Design Foundation (IxDF) Certificates

UX Management, Accessibility in Practice, HCI, Design Thinking